

Shortening your Thundermail calendar name

Your calendar is called something long with your email address in it. Here is how to change that.

Thundermail names your calendar after your account, so it arrives as something like `Nemo Thundermail Calendar (nemo@thundermail.com)`. That is long enough to be cut off in Thunderbird's calendar list, and it puts your email address on your screen and in any screenshot you take.

Neither Thunderbird nor the Thundermail website can change it today. The mail server itself is perfectly happy to, and this is a small script that asks it to. **You will need a terminal.**

1 What you need

- **An app password** — not the password you type into Thunderbird. This talks to the server the old-fashioned way, which cannot use the sign-in Thunderbird normally does. Thundermail's instructions for making one: [Create an App Password](https://support.tb.pro/hc/articles/46805020320275-Create-an-App-Password)
`https://support.tb.pro/hc/articles/46805020320275-Create-an-App-Password`
- **The address of your calendars.** In Thunderbird, right-click your calendar, choose **Properties**, and copy **Location**. Then delete the last part, so it ends just after your address. An `@` is written `%40`.
- **The tools:** `git clone https://github.com/thunderbird/desktop-support-tools`, and `uv`, which runs them.

2 See what you have

```
export CALDAV_USER='you@thundermail.com'
CAL_HOME='https://mail.thundermail.com/dav/cal/you%40thundermail.com/'

uv run caldav_list_calendars.py "$CAL_HOME" --all
```

It asks for your app password, then lists your calendars and marks the default one. Copy the long name it prints — you are about to replace it, and **nothing anywhere remembers it for you**.

3 Try the rename without doing it

```
uv run caldav_rename_calendar.py "$CAL_HOME" --only default --to "Calendar"
```

This changes nothing. It finds the calendar, prints the name it has and the name it would have, and stops. `--only` takes either the name shown in Thunderbird or the last part of the address, which is why `default` is enough here.

4 Do it

```
uv run caldav_rename_calendar.py "$CAL_HOME" --only default --to "Calendar" --rename
```

Add `--confirm` if you would rather be asked first. Check the result with the listing command from step 2.

5 Putting it back

```
uv run caldav_rename_calendar.py "$CAL_HOME" --only default \
  --to "Nemo Thundermail Calendar (nemo@thundermail.com)" --rename
```

The same command with the old name — which is why step 2 asked you to copy it.

What renaming does and does not change

Your calendar has **two** names, and this changes only one of them:

- **The friendly name** — what Thunderbird shows you in its calendar list. This is what you are shortening.
- **The address** — the web address the calendar answers at, like `.../dav/cal/you%40thundermail.com/default/`. It was decided when the calendar was created and **nothing ever changes it**, renaming included.

So a calendar created as "Book club" keeps the address `.../book-club/` for ever, even after you rename it to something else entirely. The address is a fossil of the original name, and that turns out to be useful: it is the one label that cannot have drifted, which is why the script accepts it too — `--only default` above is an address, not a name.

What to expect afterwards

- **Nothing needs re-adding.** Because the address is unchanged, every device already subscribed to this calendar stays subscribed, and your events are untouched. Renaming is genuinely just a relabelling.
- **Thunderbird may keep showing the old name** for a while, from its own copy. That is Thunderbird, not the server; the listing command asks the server directly, so it is the one to trust.
- **Thunderbird has a rename of its own**, in the same Properties dialog. Whether that changes the name on the server or only your copy of it is still being checked. If you only want a shorter label in your own client, it is worth trying first — it needs no terminal.

One caution. This is the only supported way to change the name right now, and it is also the reason the script asks you nothing by default: it prints what it would do and stops. Run it without `--rename` first, every time. A calendar you rename by mistake is put right by renaming it again — but only if you still know what it was called.

If something goes wrong

- **"The server would not accept that username and password"** — almost always an account password where an app password is needed — see [Create an App Password](#).
- **"No calendars under ..."** — the address is one calendar rather than all of them. Take the last part off it.
- **"This account already has a calendar called ..."** — two calendars with one name cannot be told apart in Thunderbird's list, so the script refuses. Pick another name.
- **"Nothing here is called ..."** — it lists what there is instead; copy one of those names, or use the last part of the address.